12-20 第一篇

Polar Exploration: Journey to the Ends of the Earth

The Arctic and Antarctic are among the coldest and most remote places on Earth. Despite freezing temperatures, strong winds, and long periods of darkness, humans have been drawn to explore these regions for centuries. Early explorers risked their lives to map unknown lands and reach the poles. Today, scientists continue to visit the ice to study climate, wildlife, and how these fragile environments are changing. [1]

Polar regions are home to unique wildlife. Penguins live only in the Southern Hemisphere, mostly in Antarctica, while polar bears roam the Arctic. Seals, whales, and countless birds depend on the icy waters for food. The extreme cold has shaped special adaptations—thick fur, layers of fat, and behaviors that help animals survive. However, as the climate warms, ice melts and habitats shrink, putting many species at risk. [2]

Scientists set up research stations to study the polar environment year-round. They measure ice thickness, track animal populations, and collect data on air and ocean temperatures. This work helps us understand climate change and its effects on the rest of the world. Satellites and modern technology have made research safer and more efficient, but fieldwork in such harsh conditions still demands courage and patience. [3]

Travel to the poles is no longer limited to explorers and scientists. Some tourists now take cruises to see icebergs, penguins, and the midnight sun. Such trips raise questions about the impact of tourism on sensitive ecosystems. Strict rules aim to minimize harm, but balancing access with protection remains a challenge. [4]

Whether for science, adventure, or a deeper understanding of our planet, the polar regions continue to attract those willing to face the cold. What we learn there may help us protect these vital parts of Earth for future generations. [5]

选项

A. Polar exploration has evolved from a race for glory into a crucial effort to understand and protect some of Earth's most important environments. B. Understanding how these animals survive helps us appreciate both their resilience and the urgency of protecting their homes. C. For this reason, polar research provides essential information for global climate policy and conservation efforts. D. As a result, the growth of polar tourism calls for careful management and respect for these fragile places. E. The poles remind us that some of the most valuable knowledge comes from places that test human limits. F. For example, Ernest Shackleton's 1914 expedition to Antarctica became famous for his leadership in saving his crew after their ship was crushed by ice.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍北极南极极寒偏远、人类数世纪来被吸引探索、早期探险家冒险绘图抵极、今日科学家继续研究气候野生动物及环境变化，空后需总结极地探索的演变与意义。A的"evolved from a race for glory into a crucial effort to understand and protect"与前文历史与现状呼应。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前说极地有独特 wildlife、企鹅仅在南半球、北极熊在北极、海豹鲸鱼鸟类依赖冰海、严寒塑造适应、气候变暖致冰融栖息地缩减，空后需总结理解动物生存与保护家园的紧迫性。B的"Understanding how these animals survive"指代前文，"resilience and the urgency of protecting their homes"与前文对应。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说科学家建常年站点、测冰厚跟踪种群、收集气温海水数据、有助于理解气候变化及全球影响、现代技术使研究更安全高效但野外仍需勇气耐心，空后需总结极地研究的全球价值。C的"For this reason"承接前文，"essential information for global climate policy and conservation efforts"与前文呼应。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前说极地旅行不再限于科考、有游客乘船看冰山企鹅极昼、引发旅游对敏感生态影响的讨论、有严格规定减害、但平衡进入与保护仍是挑战，空后需总结旅游增长对管理的要求。D的"As a result"承接前文，"careful management and respect for these fragile places"与前文对应。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前说无论为科学、冒险或更懂地球、极地仍吸引愿面对严寒的人、在那里所学或有助于为后代保护这些关键区域，空后需总结极地的启示。E的"The poles remind us"与前文呼应，"most valuable knowledge comes from places that test human limits"与前文对应。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, Ernest Shackleton's 1914 expedition...**：以For example开头，为具体探险案例（沙克尔顿）。各空均为概括或过渡句；[1]易被误选因涉及探险

历史，但该空需总结极地探索从荣耀竞赛到理解保护的演变，而非补充某次探险的细节。